CCSU BCA | SEMESTER I

General English - I

Vocabulary, grammar, writing, comprehension and speaking

COURSE CODE	BCA-1005T | Archive label: 19011
SEMESTER	BCA Semester I
SYLLABUS	CCSU BCA 2025-26 / NEP

The 2025 paper shows that this course tests communication in several forms. Build accuracy through small daily exercises, and use clear structure for every longer written answer.

Targeting 80+ is a study goal, not a guaranteed result. Use these notes with class material, the current syllabus and timed paper practice.

How to use this guide

Learn the short unit summary first. Then answer each question without looking, compare your answer with the model, and rewrite it in your own words. For calculations and programs, write every step and test with a small example.

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Unit I | Vocabulary building

Vocabulary questions test word meaning, word formation and appropriate use. Learn words in context rather than as isolated lists.

Core ideas to remember

- A root carries a core meaning; prefixes and suffixes change meaning or grammatical role.
- Synonyms have similar meanings, but may differ in tone or context; antonyms express contrast.
- Use standard abbreviations only when the audience and setting allow them.
- Keep a personal list with the word, meaning, example sentence and one related word.

Important questions with model answers

Question: What are synonyms and antonyms? Give examples.

Model answer

Synonyms are words with similar meanings, such as begin and start. Antonyms express contrasting meanings, such as early and late. The words are not always interchangeable: begin a project is natural, while start a project is also possible, but usage depends on context. In an exam, provide the definition and use each word in a short sentence.

Question: Explain how prefixes and suffixes form new words.

Model answer

A prefix is added before a base word; for example, re- in rewrite means again. A suffix is added after a base and may change meaning or word class; teach becomes teacher, while kind becomes kindness. Check spelling changes and part of speech. The best answer identifies the base, affix and resulting meaning.

Unit II | Basic writing skills

Good writing has complete sentences, logical paragraph structure, precise wording and punctuation that helps readers follow the meaning.

Core ideas to remember

- A phrase lacks a complete subject-predicate structure; a clause contains a subject and verb.
- A paragraph usually develops one main idea with a topic sentence, support and a concluding or linking sentence.
- Coherence comes from logical order, repeated key terms and transitions such as however, therefore and for example.
- Prefer precise verbs and remove words that do not add meaning.

Important questions with model answers

Question: How can coherence be improved in a paragraph?

Model answer

Begin with one clear main idea. Arrange supporting points in a logical order, such as time, importance or cause and effect. Use pronouns only when their reference is clear, repeat essential terms when needed, and use transitions to show relationships. Remove sentences that do not support the main point. Read the paragraph aloud to find abrupt changes.

Question: What are simple, compound and complex sentences?

Model answer

A simple sentence has one independent clause: The student revised. A compound sentence joins independent clauses: The student revised, and she solved a paper. A complex sentence has an independent clause and a dependent clause: The student revised because the exam was near. Sentence variety can make writing clearer, but overly long sentences should be divided.

Unit III | Common errors in writing

Proofread in layers: first check meaning and sentence structure, then agreement, verb tense, articles, prepositions and redundancy.

Core ideas to remember

- A singular subject takes a singular verb: Each student has submitted the work.
- A pronoun should match its reference and grammatical role: The teacher praised them, not they.
- Use a, an and the according to sound, specificity and whether the reader knows which item is meant.
- A misplaced modifier sits too far from the word it describes.
- Avoid redundant pairs such as advance planning when planning already means preparation in advance.

Important questions with model answers

Question: Correct and explain: Each of the students have submitted their assignment.

Model answer

Correct: Each of the students has submitted an assignment. The subject is each, which is singular, so the verb is has. In formal agreement exercises, an assignment is the clearest singular noun phrase. In ordinary modern usage, singular they is also common when referring to a person whose gender is unknown, but it does not change the verb: Each student has submitted their assignment.

Question: Correct: She advised them to keep doing there best in future.

Model answer

Correct: She advised them to keep doing their best in the future. Their is a possessive determiner meaning belonging to them; there refers to a place. The phrase in the future is the usual form. Proofreading should check homophones as well as grammar, because spell-check may accept both there and their.

Unit IV | Nature and style of sensible writing

Descriptive, definitional and classificatory writing each has a different purpose. Choose the structure that matches the task and support claims with examples.

Core ideas to remember

- A definition identifies a term, explains its distinguishing features and may give examples.
- A classification states the principle used to divide a topic and explains each category.
- A description organizes details by space, sequence or importance.
- An introduction presents the topic and direction; a conclusion answers the prompt and closes the argument.

Important questions with model answers

Question: How should a definitional essay be organized?

Model answer

Start with a clear definition of the term. Explain its main features, boundaries and significance. Add examples and, where useful, distinguish it from a related term. Organize the body into paragraphs with one function each. The conclusion should restate the meaning in a fresh way and explain why it matters. For a broad concept such as success, avoid defining it only as wealth or fame.

Question: How do you write a classification paragraph?

Model answer

Name the whole group and state the basis for dividing it. Introduce each category and describe its defining features. Use parallel wording so categories are easy to compare, and provide an example for each. Make sure the categories do not overlap in a confusing way. End by explaining what the classification helps the reader understand.

Unit V | Writing practices

Comprehension checks understanding; a precis compresses a passage while preserving its central argument; an essay develops a focused idea.

Core ideas to remember

- For comprehension, identify the main idea, supporting details, tone and the meaning of words from context.
- For a precis, read twice, identify the thesis, remove examples and repetition, use your own words and retain the logical order.
- A precis is substantially shorter than the source; follow any word limit or ratio stated in the exam.
- An essay needs a focused thesis, connected paragraphs, examples and a conclusion that follows from the argument.

Important questions with model answers

Question: What are the steps for writing a precis?

Model answer

Read the passage once for its overall message and again to mark the main claim and supporting points. Remove illustrations, repeated ideas and minor details. Draft a shorter version in your own words while preserving the original meaning and order. Check that it is objective, coherent and within the required length. Add a suitable title if asked. Do not add an opinion absent from the passage.

Question: How should a short essay be planned under time pressure?

Model answer

Spend a few minutes identifying the prompt's key term and choosing one clear position. Make a three-part outline: introduction and thesis, two or three body points with examples, and conclusion. Write one main idea per paragraph. Leave time to check sentence boundaries, agreement, punctuation and whether each paragraph answers the prompt.

Unit VI | Oral communication

Speaking and listening involve more than correct words. Clear articulation, stress, rhythm, intonation and attentive listening help a message reach its audience.

Core ideas to remember

- Pronunciation concerns how a sound or word is produced; stress makes a syllable or word more prominent.
- Intonation is the rise and fall of pitch across an utterance; it can signal question, emphasis or attitude.
- In conversation, listen fully, ask relevant follow-up questions and avoid interrupting.
- Workplace communication should be respectful, concise and suited to the listener.
- A formal presentation needs a purpose, signposted sections, examples and a clear closing.

Important questions with model answers

Question: Explain stress, rhythm and intonation.

Model answer

Stress gives prominence to a syllable or word. Rhythm is the pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables in connected speech. Intonation is the pitch movement across a phrase or sentence. Together they help listeners identify focus, contrast and whether a speaker is asking, concluding or expressing uncertainty. Effective communication uses these features naturally and clearly, not by speaking loudly.

Question: How does a formal presentation differ from a casual conversation?

Model answer

A formal presentation has a planned purpose and structure, uses language suited to the audience, and usually has limited time. It opens by stating the topic, develops a small number of organized points with examples, and ends with a summary or action. A casual conversation is more interactive and can shift topics spontaneously. Both require clear speech and attention to the listener.

Paper pattern and topic analysis

The December 2025 paper transcription reports a 3-hour, 75-mark exam: five 3-mark very short answers, any two of three 7.5-mark short answers, and any three of five 15-mark long answers. The syllabus lists 25 internal plus 75 external marks.

The 2025 paper sampled vocabulary, articles, subject-verb agreement, abbreviations and intonation in short answers; coherence, classification and presentation in medium answers; and precis, sentence structure, definition writing, oral communication and proofreading in long answers. This is one verified year for the new course, so it shows breadth but cannot establish a repeating multi-year trend.

What to prioritize

- Revise vocabulary and grammar in short daily sets; use each new word in a sentence.
- Practise paragraph coherence, sentence types, definitions and classification.
- Write at least two precis and two essays under a time limit.
- Read answers aloud and proofread agreement, articles, prepositions and word choice.

Last-five-year archive check

The CCSUStudy archive lists General English-I for BCA Semester I in December 2025 (archive label 19011). For earlier years, the archive lists Business Communication, a different course. It is not used as a substitute for General English-I, though its written and workplace-communication topics may be useful background.

How to read the evidence

The current unit list is taken from the 2025-26 syllabus reproduction. The 2025 pattern and question themes are from a third-party transcription and the archive listing. No multi-year recurrence is claimed for the new course.

Learning resources and source list

The paper archive is a discovery aid, not the university's official syllabus. The current course titles and units below follow the 2025-26 CCSU syllabus reproduced by an affiliated college. Older paper titles are identified as legacy or related material wherever they differ.

CCSU BCA syllabus and unit list (2025-26 reproduction)

CCSUStudy BCA question-paper archive

December 2025 General English-I question transcription

SWAYAM Technical English for Engineers, IIT Madras

Purdue OWL: Paragraphs and Paragraphing

Purdue OWL: Proofreading for Errors

Coverage note: no question bank can predict the exact paper. Treat the priority list as a revision map and prepare every listed unit.